

1. Open letters about AI development

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-02T04:16:52+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/2/open-letters/#atom-everything>

Open letters about AI development I wrote this summary of the past few weeks of open letters as a section of my sponsors-only newsletter but I've decided to share it here as well. Open Weights and American AI Leadership was shepherded by Microsoft, dated July 24th, and signed by 235 AI-adjacent companies including NVIDIA, Amazon, Y Combinator, The Linux Foundation and (a later signer) OpenAI. It's clearly an argument designed to counter any instincts by the current US government to ban or limit open weight models over "safety" concerns - a reasonable consideration given what happened to Claude Fable 5 ! Relying solely on closed models is not inherently safe: they can be breached, misused, or fail in ways that outsiders cannot detect. And concentrating advanced AI capabilities behind a small number of closed models compounds that risk. It results in a small number of single points of failure, weakens competition, and leaves critical technology in the hands of a few providers. Open weight models, on the other hand, allow a broad community of researchers and developers to examine their behavior, identify vulnerabilities, develop safeguards, and improve them over time. The one surpris...

2. July 2026 newsletter

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-02T04:12:41+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/2/july-newsletter/#atom-everything>

The June edition of my sponsors-only monthly newsletter is out. If you are a sponsor (or if you start a sponsorship now) you can access it here . This month: Accidental cyberattacks by OpenAI and Anthropic models under test GPT-5.6 Sol, Terra, and Luna Claude Opus 5 Kimi K3 and DeepSeek-V4-Flash-0731 Open letters about AI development A fireside chat and a podcast Reigniting my interest in MCP Other model releases My projects What I'm using at the moment Here's a copy of the June newsletter as a preview of what you'll get. Pay \$10/month to stay a month ahead of the free copy! Tags: newsletter

3. Quoting Greg Brockman

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-01T22:29:44+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/1/greg-brockman/#atom-everything>

at openai, many people hook their chatgpt up to slack. people really don't like when a coworker's chatgpt contacts them asking for help with a task, even when they'd be perfectly happy doing that same work if asked by that coworker. reinforces how much people care about human relationships and helping each other, and want AI to give time back ? or enhance time together ? rather than become a layer separating people. ? Greg Brockman , President and Co-Founder, OpenAI Tags: ai-ethics , ai-misuse , generative-ai , openai , ai , llms

4. The Apple Upgrade Situation

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-01T16:30:40Z

Link: <https://randsinrepose.com/archives/the-apple-upgrade-situation/>

Michael Lopp, at Rands in Repose: I have felt since it was announced that the Apple iPhone Upgrade Program has not just been a deal, but a steal. The specifics: You apply for a loan for a full-price iPhone at 0%. If approved, your payments are split over 24 months. Pay for 24 months, and the phone is yours. That was just the deal; the steal was that it was low effort every single year to get a new phone. I'd re-up for a new phone, and Apple would forgive the remaining payments of the loan because I'd signed up for another 24 months. Oh, and bonus, AppleCare was included, which was a total steal because I hate iPhone cases (iPhones are designed to be felt) and, uh, also I have been known to drop my phone. [...] At first glance, the new plan looks cheaper. The original plan: one year of iPhone 17 Pro (256GB, \$1,099 sticker) was ~\$57/month. 12 payments, trade-in, restart: ~\$684 for the year . The new one, same phone: \$45.99/month on the 12-month lease: \$552 for the year . But wait! The first and most

important change to the new plan is that AppleCare is no longer included . Adding it back to this phone at \$13.99/month: \$720 for the year . That's probably the single best argument for...

5. Apple Q3 2026 Results

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-01T16:15:15Z

Link: <https://sixcolors.com/post/2026/07/apple-announces-record-q3-results/>

Jason Snell: On Thursday, Apple announced record third-quarter earnings , with total revenue of \$109.4B, up 16 percent from the year-ago quarter. iPhone revenue was up 22%, Mac revenue was up 10.4%, Services revenue was up 12%, and Wearables revenue was up 6%. iPad revenue was down 6%. Six Colors also has their usual transcript of the analyst call , Tim Cook's 90th and final one. Over at MacRumors, Juli Clover wrote a retrospective on Tim Cook's 15-year run as CEO : When Cook took over as CEO, Apple's revenue for all of 2011 was \$108 billion. Apple reported \$109.4 billion for Q3 2026, earning its 2011 revenue in a single quarter. We don't have the numbers for fiscal 2026 yet, but in fiscal 2025, revenue was \$416 billion. [...] A day after Cook took over in August 2011, Apple's stock price was \$13.35 (split-adjusted). Today, it opened at \$304.81, a roughly 23x increase. Apple did alright under Cook. ?

6. The Differences Between the New 'Apple Upgrade' and the Old 'iPhone Upgrade Program'

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-30T15:56:10Z

Link: <https://9to5mac.com/2026/07/30/apple-upgrade-vs-iphone-upgrade-program-here-are-the-key-differences/>

Ryan Christoffel, writing for 9to5Mac: Apple Upgrade launched this week, and the iPhone Upgrade Program is being discontinued as a result. But despite some similarities, the two offerings are not the same. Here are the key differences. I wrote yesterday that there seemingly is no catch with the new Apple Upgrade program, but there's at least one, which Christoffel's piece doesn't note. When you lease an iPhone through Apple Upgrade, you need a cellular account on one of the big three U.S. carriers: AT&T, T-Mobile, or Verizon. That kind of stinks, and I'm not quite sure I understand why. You're leasing the iPhone through Apple and Klarna, not the carrier, so I don't know why Apple cares. If you know why, shoot me a message and explain it. Is it just a simplistic credit-risk evaluation, where prepaid plan-holders and MVNO users in general are viewed suspiciously? I've been hearing a lot of good things about the higher-quality MVNOs, especially US Mobile . (Quinn Nelson mentioned last week on The Talk Show that he's on US Mobile.) But if you're not on one of the big three you can't lease an iPhone through Apple Upgrade. (I think the old iPhone Upgrade Program required you to have a...

7. Making an agile version of a Windows Runtime delegate in C++/WinRT, part 10

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 31 Jul 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260731-00/?p=112578>

What failure of the context callback means. The post Making an agile version of a Windows Runtime delegate in C++/WinRT, part 10 appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Why polynomial coefficients?

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 01 Aug 2026 20:18:41 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/01/why-polynomial-coefficients/>

Second order linear differential equations with polynomial coefficients form their own area of study. This seems like a narrow class of equations, but it's very important in applications. This class of equations seems like a mathematically natural topic, but why is it so important in applications? I did a PhD in differential equations without ever [?] The post Why polynomial coefficients? first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Counting rooted trees

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 01 Aug 2026 16:15:53 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/01/counting-rooted-trees/>

Combinatorial problems can be interesting for their own sake, but they are more interesting when there is a connection to a problem outside combinatorics, and the more unexpected the

connection the better. Counting the number of unlabeled rooted trees [1] with n nodes is a pure mathematics problem. Designing numerical methods for solving differential equations [?] The post Counting rooted trees first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Runge-Kutta order versus stages

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 01 Aug 2026 15:58:15 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/01/butcher-barrier/>

The textbook version of the Runge-Kutta method for solving differential equations has 4 stages and has 4th order error. For lower order versions of RK the number of stages s also matches the order of the error p . But in order to achieve error on the order of $p \geq 5$, you need more than p [?] The post Runge-Kutta order versus stages first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Gadget Review: HIKMICRO D02 Thermal Camera ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sat, 01 Aug 2026 11:34:43 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/gadget-review-hikmicro-d02-thermal-camera/>

The good folks at Hikmicro have sent me their D02 Infrared Camera to review. It's part of their "Eco" series of thermal imagers - designed to be easy to use around the home and relatively cheap. Despite the no-fills appearance, it packs in a lot of features which put some more expensive models to shame. It even works with Linux. Shove in a USB-C cable to grab the photos or even use it as a?

12. Reading List 08/01/26

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 01 Aug 2026 12:04:01 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-080126>

Pepper-spray drones, China's chip Manhattan Project, Commonwealth Fusion's fundraise, and a proposed Dulles Airport renovation.

13. This Week in Package Management: 1 August 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-08-01T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/08/01/this-week-in-package-management.html>

Week eleven of the roundup, built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon . Releases mise 2026.7.14?18 : the default shell-argument settings are now global-only, so an untrusted repo's local config can't influence command execution before trust evaluation runs. Experimental task output caching restores a task's declared outputs and replays logs when its sources, tools and environment are unchanged, and experimental monorepo tasks now infer Node workspace dependency edges and import package.json scripts as node: # tasks. Verdaccio 6.9.0 requires Node.js 22 as the minimum runtime and ships a dual CJS+ESM build with an exports field, so import { runServer } from 'verdaccio' resolves a real ES module. The bundled @verdaccio/config moves to js-yaml 4.3.0, resolving GHSA-52cp-r559-cp3m . setup-uv v9.0.0 flips the prune-cache default to false to reduce load on PyPI infrastructure. The major bump reflects that workflows may see higher GitHub Actions cache usage as a result; the reasoning is written up in #967 . Renovate 43.282.0 has the mise manager run mise lock in the MISE_SAFE=1 mode added last week , so lockfile updates against unt...

14. MkLinux and the pimped-out Apple Workgroup Server 9150

Source: Old Vintage Computing Research | Published: 2026-08-01T19:54:02.560-07:00

Link: <https://oldvcr.blogspot.com/2026/08/mklinux-and-pimped-out-apple-workgroup.html>

As is typical here in the Floodgap lab, it all started so innocently: rebuilding a flaky Apple Workgroup Server 9150, the odd duck of the Workgroup Server line and older cousin to our beloved Apple Network Server. And then I just had to pimp it out for MkLinux. Before the sui generis IBM AIX-based Apple Network Server , one of our favourite machines here at Floodgap, there were the WGSes, the Workgroup Servers, Apple's well-intentioned but conflictly received line of Macintosh rebadges hopped up with high-spec options and special server software. While certain users had long repurposed desktop Macs as ad-hoc servers, these computers were the first Apple systems explicitly positioned and sold as such, and the first

generation was even advertised with A/UX, Apple's own hybrid System V UNIX implementation. A/UX ultimately didn't survive the 1994 68K transition to PowerPC, but in 1996 Apple publicly offered another option: run Linux, using the Mach microkernel. Although MkLinux emerged after the 9150's discontinuation, it's still just an overgrown NuBus Power Mac, so between more RAM, a beefier CPU upgrade and various video cards, by the end of this article we ought to have a confi...

15. Pluralistic: Why businesses lie about AI (01 Aug 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Sat, 01 Aug 2026 12:29:28 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/08/01/dare-snot/>

Today's links Why businesses lie about AI: Humoring the boss all the way into bankruptcy. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Vinge x NYT; Syklarov x publishers; Human hair castles; Gingrich's bot army; Accessibility v Web DRM; David Byrne x WinXP; Furies don't fuck in fursuits; AI's pogo-stick grift. Upcoming appearances: Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Why businesses lie about AI (permalink) Neoclassical economics assumes rationality. The corollary of, "If you're so smart, why aren't you rich?" is "you're rich, so you must be very smart!" Thus it is that many people assume that if powerful, well-compensated CEOs insist that "AI is changing everything," well then, AI must be changing everything. But the evidence for this "changing everything" thesis is thin on the ground. Despite a global mania that has reduced the real, pressing need for digital sovereignty to the imaginary need to create "sovereign AI," no one can really articulate the case for "sovereign AI..."

16. Put A Tag On It

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-08-01T20:18:00Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17399769/pricing-guns-vs-barcodes-history>

The pricing gun should have been a dead technology years before it actually was. But state laws artificially kept it around as a shield against the scary barcode.

17. I'm (mostly) picking models on speed now, not intelligence

Source: Martin Alderson | Published: Sun, 02 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: https://martinalderson.com/posts/speed-vs-intelligence/?utm_source=rss&utm_medium=rss&utm_campaign=feed

For the first time I'm choosing my daily driver models on tokens per second rather than raw intelligence. Why ~100tok/s might be the new 100ms, where the speed gains stop mattering, and the price war that's coming.